

Accessibility audit: Galaxium Travels sample app (Flights and Sign In)

Audit ID	EAR-2026-09-001 (v1.1)
Date	25 September 2026; v1.1 same day: F-02 and F-03 key scripts adjusted after the F-01 fix moved initial focus to the dialog container
Auditor	py-tr (self-authored)
Target	IBM Galaxium Travels sample application, commit e4e18ae, run locally (frontend <code>http://localhost:5173</code>)
Standard	WCAG 2.2, Level AA
Method	Keyboard only; NVDA 2026.2 screen reader with Google Chrome on Windows 11; visual inspection; source inspection where noted
Scope	The <code>/flights</code> page, the Sign In dialog, and the site-wide layout

Self-authored for demonstration. This is not a compliance statement or a certification. Context: the European Accessibility Act (Directive (EU) 2019/882) has applied since 28 June 2025 and covers e-commerce and passenger-transport booking services; Galaxium Travels is a sample app used here for illustration.

How to reproduce

Start state for every key script: open `/flights`, signed out, with the Filters panel collapsed. Put keyboard focus on the first flight card's "Select Seat Class" button (Earth → Mars). NVDA running, Chrome in the foreground.

Verification column: "ear" means the finding is verified by what NVDA announces for the key script. "human" means a person must judge the result; a screen-reader transcript cannot decide it.

Summary of findings

ID	WCAG success criterion	Location	Severity	Verification
F-01	4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A); 2.4.3 Focus Order (A)	Sign In dialog	High	ear
F-02	2.4.3 Focus Order (A)	Sign In dialog	High	ear
F-03	1.3.1 Info and Relationships (A); 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A)	Sign In form fields	Medium	ear
N-01	2.2.2 Pause, Stop, Hide (A)	Animated starfield background, every page	Medium	human
N-02	4.1.3 Status Messages (AA)	<code>/flights</code> results count	Medium	human

Findings

F-01: The Sign In dialog is not announced and does not receive focus

Key script	Enter, Tab
Observed	After Enter, the Sign In dialog appears on screen but NVDA announces nothing. The next Tab moves to the page behind the dialog: "Moon, link, heading, level 3".
Expected announcement	"Sign In, dialog", then "Close modal, button"
Impact	A screen-reader user cannot find the dialog, so cannot sign in or book.
Verification	ear

F-02: Focus is not contained in the Sign In dialog and is lost when it closes

Key script	Enter, Tab ×6, Shift+Tab, Escape
Observed (with F-01 corrected)	After the last control ("Don't have an account? Register"), Tab leaves the dialog for the page behind it: "content info landmark, github.com, link". After Escape, focus drops to the page body and NVDA reads "link, github.com".
Expected announcement	The Tab after the last control ("Don't have an account? Register") wraps to "Close modal, button"; Shift+Tab goes back to "Don't have an account? Register". After Escape: "Select Seat Class, button" (focus returns to the control that opened the dialog). Focus never reaches the page behind the dialog.
Depends on	F-01 (focus must first enter the dialog)
Verification	ear

F-03: Sign In fields are announced by their placeholder, not their label

Key script	Enter, Tab, Tab, Tab
Observed (with F-01 corrected)	"John Doe, edit, required, blank", then "john@example.com, edit, required, blank". The visible labels "Name" and "Email" are not associated with their inputs, so the example text is read as the field name.
Expected announcement	"Close modal, button", then "Name, edit", then "Email, edit"
Depends on	F-01
Verification	ear

N-01: Background animation cannot be paused

Where	Every page: the starfield behind the content twinkles and drifts continuously.
Observed	The animation starts automatically, runs indefinitely alongside the content, and has no pause, stop or hide control. (Also noted, outside 2.2.2: it does not respond to the operating system's "reduce motion" setting; source inspection shows no reduced-motion check in the canvas animation loop.)
Expected	A mechanism for the user to pause, stop or hide the animation (required by SC 2.2.2). Recommended practice, not required by 2.2.2: also honour the operating system's "reduce motion" setting (prefers-reduced-motion; related to SC 2.3.3, Level AAA).
Verification	human. The problem is visual motion; a screen-reader transcript cannot show it.

N-02: The results count is not announced when it changes

Key script	Move focus to the search box, type "Mars"
Observed	The visible text "Showing N flights" updates as the user types, but it is not a status message (source inspection: no live region), so screen-reader users are not told the result changed.
Expected	The new count is announced politely, without interrupting typing.
Verification	human. Whether an announcement interrupts typing is a judgement about timing and frequency; a transcript alone cannot decide it.